



TARGETED SELECTION®

INTERVIEW GUIDE

Job Opening Product Engineering-Senior Product Engineer

Candidate _____

Interviewer _____

Date _____

Interviewer A (Expert)



INTERVIEW PREPARATION

1. Review candidate materials.
2. If assigned, prepare to conduct the Key Background Review to seek relevant information about the candidate's educational background, work history, knowledge, experiences, and motivations.
3. Prepare the Planned Behavioral Questions section.
 - Review the definitions and key actions.
 - If necessary, modify questions to better fit the candidate's knowledge and experience as well as the target position.
 - Determine the order in which you'll ask the questions for each target.
 - Develop additional questions if necessary.

Note: Your goal is to collect three complete STARS for each target.
4. Estimate the time needed to cover each section of the Interview Guide
 - To help stay on track during the interview, record start times at the top of each page in the guide.



INTERVIEW OPENING

1. Greet the candidate, stating your name and position.
2. Explain the interview's purpose: To make sure you and the candidate get the information needed to make good decisions.
3. Describe the interview plan, explaining that you will:
 - Briefly review the candidate's education and work history (if assigned).
 - Ask questions to get specific information about the candidate's jobs, experiences, and knowledge.
 - Provide information and answer the candidate's questions about the organization and the position.
4. Explain that you will take notes throughout the interview.
5. Make the transition to the first section.



KEY BACKGROUND REVIEW

EDUCATIONAL BACKGROUND (do not seek information provided on resume)

Graduate School _____ Years _____ Degree/Major _____ GPA _____ out of _____

College _____ Years _____ Degree/Major _____ GPA _____ out of _____

Technical School _____ Years _____ Degree/Major _____ GPA _____ out of _____

High School _____ Years _____ Degree/Major _____ GPA _____ out of _____

1. What other education or training have you had?
2. How did your education/training prepare you for a job such as this?
3. Which classes did you enjoy the most? Why?
4. Which classes did you enjoy the least? Why?

Notes:

WORK HISTORY

Job _____ Dates of employment _____

1. Why do/did you want to leave this job?
2. Describe your duties and responsibilities in your job.
3. What do/did you like most/least about your job?
4. (If applicable) Why did you take a break from the workforce?

Notes:

Job _____ Dates of employment _____

1. Why do/did you want to leave this job?
2. Describe your duties and responsibilities in your job.
3. What do/did you like most/least about your job?
4. (If applicable) Why did you take a break from the workforce?

Notes:

PLANNED BEHAVIORAL QUESTIONS



Driving for Sustainable Results

Perseveres in achieving objectives even in the face of adversity (steps forward to address difficult challenges and issues).

Key Actions

- Does not easily give up in the face of unexpected obstacles.
- Performs tasks outside of own area of responsibility when needed.
- Balances individual and team performance in achieving objectives.
- Puts in extra effort and work to accomplish critical or difficult tasks.
- Maintains a consistently high level of productivity.
- Focuses efforts on both processes and results.
- Demonstrates a strong drive to achieve meaningful meeting outcomes.

RATING

1. Describe a time when you were particularly effective at achieving end results.
2. Achieving required work goals or objectives is not always easy. Describe a difficult goal that you were able to achieve. Why was it difficult?
3. Sometimes, you have to take some risks to increase your chance of success. Tell me about a recent risk that you took in your job.

Situation/Task

Action

Result

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...
Why did you...?
What were the circumstances surrounding...?
What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?
Describe specifically how you did that.
What did you do first? Second?
Describe your specific role.
Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?
How did it work out?
What happened as a result?
What feedback have you gotten?



Innovating with Courage

Generating innovative solutions in work situations; trying different and novel ways to deal with work problems and opportunities.

Key Actions

- Challenges paradigms.
- Generates innovative ideas, solutions, and opportunities.
- Routinely tries out new ideas, methods, and technologies.
- Takes action in an uncertain environment with courage and conviction.
- Takes reasoned risks to introduce innovations.

RATING

1. Tell me about a time when you worked with others to develop new and creative ideas to solve problems.
2. Tell me about what you've done to develop new and creative solutions to business problems. Give me an example of a specific approach you developed.
3. Give me an example of a time when you were able to apply existing knowledge in a new way in order to solve a problem.

Situation/Task

Action

Result

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...
Why did you...?
What were the circumstances surrounding...?
What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?
Describe specifically how you did that.
What did you do first? Second?
Describe your specific role.
Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?
How did it work out?
What happened as a result?
What feedback have you gotten?



Making Sound Decisions

Identifying and understanding issues, problems, and opportunities; comparing data from different sources to draw conclusions; using effective approaches for choosing a course of action or developing appropriate solutions; taking action that is consistent with available facts, constraints, and probable consequences.

Key Actions

- Uses appropriate knowledge and expertise in making decisions.
- Considers alternative solutions before making decisions.
- Bases decisions on sound logic and rationale.
- Drives towards success.
- Chooses appropriate action.
- Makes timely decisions on problems or issues requiring immediate attention.
- Makes sound decisions on complex functional issues and problems.
- Applies prudent financial judgment in decisions and actions.
- Creates contingency plans to ensure success.

RATING

options?

② redesign

① fix on floor

how fast you bought it up.

1. Tell me about a time when you had to analyze or interpret numerical or financial information.
2. We've all tried to solve a problem on our own only to discover that others needed to be involved in the solution. Give me an example of a time when you took full responsibility for solving a problem but later found out that you should have included others in the process.
3. Describe a time when you weighed the pros and cons of a situation and decided not to take action, even though you were under pressure to do so.

What was at stake?

Situation/Task

Action

Result

During Gizzly, we manufactured 130 gummy str. in shop. I owned assembly process.

Task was: get this done and send to factory. on at PMGNS was ladder assembly and was weak.

Was told factory needed ladders and I refused. B/c was feeling them and when I checked, they bent. Found weak support at corner.

* A lot of "ahs"
* Need more data/metrics

~~1) I saw director and told that I'm not easily ble of safety.~~

2 options I laid out to director:
~~1) send it~~
2) strengthen the ladder

Feedback:

1) More detail.

2) SX?

3) Process of manual. parts in non production env. 7

good decision supported by higher up.

1) supported change to loc

2) prohibited factory workers climbing on ladders

3) safety #1, paper supported me.

changed design later

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...

Why did you...?

What were the circumstances surrounding...?

What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?

Describe specifically how you did that.

What did you do first? Second?

Describe your specific role.

Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?

How did it work out?

What happened as a result?

What feedback have you gotten?



Managing and Improving Processes Key Actions

RATING

Obtaining information and identifying key issues and relationships relevant to achieving a long-range goal or vision; committing to a course of action to accomplish a long-range goal or vision after developing alternatives based on logical assumptions, facts, available resources, constraints, and organizational values.

- Promotes collaboration.
- Defines and communicates expectations for quality outcomes.
- Helps others understand their work from a process perspective.
- Defines and communicates process management tools and methods.
- Designates process owners who are accountable for successful execution.
- Helps others understand the impact of variation and how to manage it.
- Analyzes process breakdowns to ensure that lessons are learned.
- Identifies ways to streamline and/or improve efficiency of future work.
- Establishes best practices.
- Integrates input from stakeholders to prioritize process improvement efforts.
- Ensures currency of process standards and process documentation.
- Implements information tracking.

1. Describe a time when you had to establish priorities to implement a new vision or directive. What information did you use or obtain to determine the priorities?
2. Describe a time when you recommended a plan of action in response to business / market trends. How did you come up with this plan?
3. Describe a time when you had to significantly modify work procedures so they aligned with new strategic directives.

3min. 20sec

Situation/Task

Was lead QE for hardware who build
Grazely combiner.

3 vision events camera - FLV camera not giving
signal or weak.

T- find root cause and proper solution
only 6 months from production!

Action

Gathered team, didn't see twist
in wire.

Twist was not in supplier spec

Requested customer service rep to
come fix hardware.

- Gathered design engineers and talked
about drying parts.

- Set up meeting recurring to drive
hardware changes.

- Prints (given by ISB) sent to supplier.

Result

- We got implemented
and PLAP done.

- LL - can be resolved
in PDR if we
have that aligned.

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...

Why did you...?

What were the circumstances
surrounding...?

What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?

Describe specifically how you did that.

What did you do first? Second?

Describe your specific role.

Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?

How did it work out?

What happened as a result?

What feedback have you
gotten?

I aligned team and changed to stakeholders.



Managing and Improving Processes Key Actions

RATING

Obtaining information and identifying key issues and relationships relevant to achieving a long-range goal or vision; committing to a course of action to accomplish a long-range goal or vision after developing alternatives based on logical assumptions, facts, available resources, constraints, and organizational values.

- Promotes collaboration.
- Defines and communicates expectations for quality outcomes.
- Helps others understand their work from a process perspective.
- Defines and communicates process management tools and methods.
- Designates process owners who are accountable for successful execution.
- Helps others understand the impact of variation and how to manage it.
- Analyzes process breakdowns to ensure that lessons are learned.
- Identifies ways to streamline and/or improve efficiency of future work.
- Establishes best practices.
- Integrates input from stakeholders to prioritize process improvement efforts.
- Ensures currency of process standards and process documentation.
- Implements information tracking.

1. Describe a time when you had to establish priorities to implement a new vision or directive. What information did you use or obtain to determine the priorities?
2. Describe a time when you recommended a plan of action in response to business / market trends. How did you come up with this plan?
3. Describe a time when you had to significantly modify work procedures so they aligned with new strategic directives.

Situation/Task

Action

Result

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...
Why did you...?
What were the circumstances surrounding...?
What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?
Describe specifically how you did that.
What did you do first? Second?
Describe your specific role.
Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?
How did it work out?
What happened as a result?
What feedback have you gotten?



Technical / Professional Knowledge and Skills

Having achieved a satisfactory level of technical and professional skill or knowledge in position-related areas; keeping up with current developments and trends in areas of expertise.

Key Actions

- Understands technical terminology and developments.
- Knows how to apply a technical skill or procedure.
- Knows when to apply a technical skill or procedure.
- Performs complex tasks in area of expertise.

RATING

1. Give me an example of an assignment you worked on that showed your expertise in _____.
2. Describe a project, situation, or assignment that challenged your skills as a _____. How did you approach this situation?
3. Describe how you've gone about learning a new technical task.

Situation/Task

Action

Result

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...
Why did you...?
What were the circumstances surrounding...?
What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?
Describe specifically how you did that.
What did you do first? Second?
Describe your specific role.
Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?
How did it work out?
What happened as a result?
What feedback have you gotten?



Generic Job Fit

The extent to which activities and responsibilities available in the job are consistent with the activities and responsibilities that result in personal satisfaction; the degree to which the work itself is personally satisfying.

Key Actions

- No Key Actions Associated with this competency

RATING

1. Tell me about a time when you were particularly satisfied with your work situation. Why was this situation so gratifying?
2. Looking across all of your work experience, when were you the most satisfied? What made this situation so satisfying?
3. Describe a work situation that included responsibilities that you really enjoy. What aspect(s) was most enjoyable?

Situation/Task

Action

Result

FOLLOW-UP QUESTIONS TO BUILD COMPLETE STARS

For Situation/Task

Describe a situation when...
Why did you...?
What were the circumstances surrounding...?
What were you reacting to?

For Action

Exactly what did you do?
Describe specifically how you did that.
What did you do first? Second?
Describe your specific role.
Walk me through the steps you took.

For Results

What was the result?
How did it work out?
What happened as a result?
What feedback have you gotten?



INTERVIEW CLOSE

- Ask any additional questions you believe will help you clarify and complete your notes.
- Provide your assigned information about the position, organization, or location, and ask if the candidate has any questions.
- Ask the candidate what might prevent him or her from accepting an offer if one was made.
- End by explaining the next steps in the selection process and thanking the candidate for a productive interview.



POST-INTERVIEW DATA EVALUATION

1. Evaluate the data relative to each target.

- Review each STAR to determine if it is complete and in the right target.
- Determine whether each STAR is effective or ineffective.
- Weigh each STAR by considering similarity, impact, and recency.
- Rate the overall target.

NUMERICAL RATINGS

- | | |
|----------|--|
| 5 | Much more than Acceptable (Significantly exceeds criteria for successful job performance/motivational fit) |
| 4 | More than Acceptable (Exceeds criteria for successful job performance/motivational fit) |
| 3 | Acceptable (Meets criteria for successful job performance/motivational fit) |
| 2 | Less than Acceptable (Generally does not meet criteria for successful job performance/motivational fit) |
| 1 | Much less than Acceptable (Significantly below criteria for successful job performance/motivational fit) |

CLARIFYING RATINGS

- | | |
|-----------|---|
| N | No opportunity to observe or make an assessment |
| I | Incomplete data - need more information |
| 5H | Too High - so strong in one aspect of a target as to cause weakness in another or overall |

2. Evaluate observable targets if applicable.

- Review your notes on the observable targets.
- Rate the key actions by placing a check mark in the appropriate box to note whether the candidate's behavior was positive/effective (+), neutral (0), or negative/ineffective (-).
- Note your rating for each target in the box.

Communication

Clearly conveying information and ideas through a variety of media to individuals or groups in a manner that engages the audience and helps them understand and retain the message.

+ 0 - Key Actions

☐	☐	☐	Organizes the communication
☐	☐	☐	Maintains audience attention
☐	☐	☐	Adjusts to the audience
☐	☐	☐	Ensures understanding
☐	☐	☐	Adheres to accepted conventions
☐	☐	☐	Comprehends communication from others

RATING

3. Prepare for data integration.

- Transfer your ratings to the Rating Grid. Include your comments so you can refer to them during data integration.

Candidate _____ **Interviewer** _____

Position _____ **Date** _____

Instructions: Complete this Rating Grid containing your assigned interview targets after you've interviewed the candidate and evaluated the candidate data.

Rating Grid

Assigned Targets	Rating	Comments
Driving for Sustainable Results		
Innovating with Courage		
Making Sound Decisions		
Managing and Improving Processes		
Technical / Professional Knowledge and Skills		
Generic Job Fit		
Communication		

Coverage Grid for _____ Position

	Interviewer A (Exp.)	Interviewer B (Exp.)	Interviewer C	Interviewer D				
Driving for Sustainable Results	✓	✓	✓	✓				
Influencing Effectively		✓	✓	✓				
Innovating with Courage	✓	✓						
Making Sound Decisions	✓	✓						
Managing and Improving Processes	✓	✓						
Technical / Professional Knowledge and Skills	✓	✓						
Generic Job Fit	✓		✓	✓				
Communication	✓	✓	✓	✓				

Data Integration Form

Candidate Name: _____

Competencies	Interviewers							
	Interviewer A (Exp.)	Interviewer B (Exp.)	Interviewer C	Interviewer D				Consensus
1. Driving for Sustainable Results								
2. Influencing Effectively								
3. Innovating with Courage								
4. Making Sound Decisions								
5. Managing and Improving Processes								
6. Technical / Professional Knowledge and Skills								
7. Generic Job Fit								
8. Communication								